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16. Conversation with the Resident Editor of a major newspaper in Lucknow who did not wish to be named, 12 June 2020.

17. Amit Shah interview with TNN, 'My mission was to deliver in UP, Amit Shah says', *The Times of India*, 17 May 2014, https://timesofindia.indiatimes.com/news/Election-results-2014-My-mission-was-to-deliver-in-UP-Amit-Shah-says/articleshow/35233049.cms.

18. Overall, India has a total of 2,479 castes notified as OBCs across all states. Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment, Government of India, *Handbook on Social Welfare Statistics* 2018 (New Delhi: Department of Social Justice and Empowerment, Plan Division, 2018), p. 237, http://socialjustice.nic.in/writereaddata/UploadFile/HANDBOOKSocialWelfareStatistice2018.pdf. For a detailed breakdown of UP's seventy-six OBC castes, see: 'Central list of OBCs for the state of Uttar Pradesh', http://www.bcmbcmw.tn.gov.in/obc/faq/uttarpradesh.pdf.

19. According to the 1931 Census. Christophe Jaffrelot, 'The rise of the Other Backward Classes in the Hindi belt', *The Journal of Asian Studies*, Vol. 59, No. 1, February 2000, p. 102.

20. A total of 1,284 castes are notified as SC across all Indian states. Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment, Government of India, *Handbook on Social Welfare Statistics 2018* (New Delhi: Department of Social Justice and Empowerment, Plan Division, 2018), p. 37. The full Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment list of sixty-six castes notified as SC in UP is available at: http://socialjustice.nic.in/writereaddata/UploadFile/Scan-0019.jpg.

21. Census 2011 data. See analysis by Swati Mathur, 'Jatavs on top of SC population in UP', *The Times of India*, 4 July 2015, https://timesofindia.indiatimes.com/city/lucknow/Jatavs-on-top-of-SC-population-in-UP/articleshow/47931787.cms; Census of India 2001, *Uttar Pradesh—Data Highlights: The Scheduled Castes,* https://censusindia.gov.in/tables_published/scst/dh_sc_up.pdf. For further sub-caste SC details, see Ministry of Social Justice